

Community Life Engagement Workgroup

Session 3: March 23, 2017

Focus: Guidepost 3, "Use human and social capital to decrease dependence on paid supports."

Facilitators: Jen Sulewski and Adam Sass

Recording link: <http://connectpro97884399.adobeconnect.com/p1ahhu057nh/>

SELN Hub group space: <http://www.selnhub.org/groups/home/45>

Q1a: What skills are helpful for daily activities in community settings?

- Nancy Nickolaus: Being able to ask people for help if you need it. You can do this verbally or in other ways.
- Nancy Nickolaus: Like how to use a weight machine at the Y!
- Carrie Roberts - NM: Being able to navigate the community. There are a lot of ways to do this. You can use a map or app or just know the area.
- Dana Yarbrough (VA): actively participating (versus just being present in the room)
- Doris Roberts: money management skills
- Joe Longcor, MI: Sorry. Need to leave the presentation. Important topic...lead on!
- Olga Figueroa (DC DDS): Small talk maybe
- Olga Figueroa (DC DDS): Making conversations when you're around folks to make connections
- Olga Figueroa (DC DDS): Small talk at coffee shops or on train
- Dana Yarbrough (VA): If it's an activity I chose to participate in, I am enthusiastic about being there and let those around me know I cannot wait to get started, or I wear the team's shirt, etc.
- Nancy Nickolaus: Teaching people to be observant.
- Olga Figueroa (DC DDS): Yes, it is also important to discuss personal space and appropriate touching
- Doris Roberts: How and who to seek out assistance from if lost or cannot find something in the community,
- Carrie Roberts - NM: to follow up on what Doris is saying...knowing where the restrooms are.
- Cindy Thomas: Let's be sure to consider culture though!
- Estella Ysaguirre: good communication skills
- Olga Figueroa (DC DDS): To clarify, I am referring to interactions with strangers because I had an interaction this weekend while visiting a friend when a guy from a psychiatric group home on that street walked away from the home and directly toward me and was standing less than a few inches away as I was grabbing my bag from the trunk and my partner and our friend were about to walk to the door when they turned around to find a very large guy extremely close to me talking to me as I'm grabbing my purse

Q1b: How can we support people to expand such skills so they may become more fully engaged in their communities?

- Nancy Nickolaus: Knowing the "routine" of the place where you are going. What do people typically do and how do they do it. What do they wear? Then helping people be a part of the routine.
- Nancy Nickolaus: Yes Doris!
- Allison Hall: Nancy had a good idea about staff observing a new place and seeing what the culture is like
- Nancy Nickolaus: Modeling
- Dana Yarbrough (VA): naturally modeling behaviors and skills (sometimes they are 'taught' in a room or building but don't generalize across settings so the person doesn't know what the skill looks like in the real setting
- Dana Yarbrough (VA): Best way to teach library behaviors (shhh...be quiet) is to go to the library and observe what people do and don't do. To go to a Boston Patriots (!) game and watch how people ct
- Dana Yarbrough (VA): the community should be the learning classroom/environment
- Doris Roberts: All types of education and training are best if done in real life situations and activities
- Allison Hall: agreed, Doris!
- Rie Kennedy-Lizotte: There is some to role playing with people to assist them in becoming comfortable with interactions with others
- Nancy Nickolaus: Videotaping the correct behavior/routine
- Carrie Roberts - NM: Preparing for a negative experience

Q2a.What needs to happen to build personal networks of relationships that lead to natural supports?

- Nancy Nickolaus: Making sure the person contributes to the group when they attend an event/class etc.
- Carrie Roberts - NM: Connect with people who have similar interests
- Olga Figueroa (DC DDS): Visiting the same locations often definitely helps foster these connections
- Carrie Roberts - NM: get to know your neighbors
- Carrie Roberts - NM: Talk with co-workers
- Dana Yarbrough (VA): exploring different types of relationships (some are more reciprocal in nature than others), including face to face and social media networks
- Allison Hall: making sure that staff are aware of the importance of fading and building those networks
- Carolyn Lavadie - NM: Developing a routine of community activities so that the person sees others at the same time that they frequent these places., possibly making it possible to make those natural connections.
- Rie Kennedy-Lizotte: It is important that we introduce people and then step back for a conversation to unfold

Q2b. Suzanne Freeze: How can we use social capital (connections in the community) as a form of natural supports?

- Allison Hall: also consider how we can help people identify what they could contribute. Social capital is give and take - helping PwD identify what they can bring to these relationships

Q4 What can states put in place to encourage fading of paid CLE supports?

- Nancy Nickolaus: Make sure fading is the plan at the start. Include fading strategies in the plan.
- Doris Roberts: The issues I have encountered have been around guardians not wanting their individuals to have more independence out in the community

Q3 What do we know about effective practices for fading in supported employment? How can this knowledge be translated to CLE?

- Cindy Thomas: what both has in common is that we must plan and expect some opportunity for natural supports from the start....
- John Butterworth: Yes - I think we are misleading calling it fading, it's more being playful about relationships from the start
- Nancy Nickolaus: Look for opportunities to use other supports like assistive technology/adaptations.
- Cindy Thomas: Important distinguish between reduction of paid supports and independence. Things like AT support independence and that can be very important but we are also talking about interdependence as people develop relationships and community connections
- Suzanne Freeze: Interesting to think about the AT part in a time when everyone around us is so dependent on smart phones and devices!
- Cindy Thomas: but we don't have the funding issues worked out for employment either...
- Nancy Nickolaus: having plans that clearly define what progress looks like. Then use the planning process to see if people are making progress. If not, ask why and document how you will "try another way." Part of the QA/plan monitoring process was to monitor this.

States in attendance

DC, DE, MD, MI, NM, RI, SD, VA, WA

Project team in attendance

Allison Hall, Adam Sass, Cindy Thomas, Jeanine Zlockie, Jennifer Sulewski, John Butterworth, Nancy Nickolaus, Rie Kennedy-Lizotte, Sheila Johnson, Suzanne Freeze